

The Farm & Rural Legal Service

Legal help for farmers and rural businesses

How can the Farm and Rural Legal Service help me?

The Farm and Rural Legal Service gives help and advice to Queensland rural producers and rural based businesses who:

- have severe debt related problems
- are in dispute with their lenders
- are facing financial hardship relating to their business or
- have been issued with an enforcement action notice by their bank or financier.

How much does the service cost?

The service is free for Queensland rural producers and rural businesses.

Where can I go to get help?

You can contact our Farm and Rural Legal Service by calling our contact centre on 1300 65 11 88 (for the cost of a local call) or by emailing frls@legalaid.qld.gov.au

You can meet us at your closest Legal Aid office, talk to us over the telephone or we can visit you at your farm or business. We can also organise video or telephone conferences in some regions.

What legal services do you provide?

If you're a Queensland rural producer or rural based business confronted with severe debt-related problems, the Farm and Rural Legal Service can give advice on:

- enforcement action notices
- legal documents
- legal processes
- legal options
- Queensland and Commonwealth laws including the *Farm Business Debt Mediation Act 2017* (Qld), *Farm Debt Mediation Act 1994* (NSW), and the *Credit (Rural Finance) Act 1996* (Qld)
- the conduct and actions of other parties.

We don't do any court work or prepare any court forms. We also don't do conveyancing work or work involving wills and estates.

How can you help me negotiate?

We can negotiate on your behalf by contacting people directly and by attending farm debt mediations or meetings. Negotiation and mediation can often help you resolve your problems without having to go to court.

"After years of drought, we were having trouble meeting the repayments on our property. The Farm and Rural Legal Service helped us negotiate a new payment plan with the bank so we could get back on track."



Will you actually go to meet with my bank?

Yes. We can go with you to your bank and help you sort out any disputes you may have with them.

Can you work with other people who are already helping me?

Yes. We can work with other advisers like rural financial counsellors, agronomists and accountants. Our aim is to work with everyone involved to achieve the best possible outcome.

Is your help confidential?

Yes. Our services are confidential and we are committed to protecting your privacy. We will not provide your personal information or details about your legal problem to anyone, unless we are authorised by you to do so or legally required to.

What other services do you provide?

We make submissions to state and federal governments on legal issues relating to the rural sector.

We are constantly listening to primary producers and the agribusiness sector about the major debt related issues affecting them and what they'd like to see changed.

We also help educate the community by going to meetings and talking about issues important to primary producers and rural businesses.

Do you need extra help accessing our services?

We are committed to making our services accessible to people from non-English-speaking backgrounds and people with disabilities.

If you would like information explained in your language, please phone the Translating and Interpreting Service on 13 1450 to speak to an interpreter. Ask them to connect you to Legal Aid Queensland. If you are deaf or have a hearing impairment you can contact us using the National Relay Service. To make a call, go to the National Relay Service website and ask for 1300 65 11 88 (Legal Aid Queensland's legal information line). These are free services.

How do I provide feedback or make a complaint?

Your feedback—complaints, compliments and suggestions—is welcome and we take it seriously.

To make a comment about the service you received from Legal Aid Queensland, you can complete our client feedback form. The form is available from your local Legal Aid office and our website.

You can also give us feedback by:
writing to us at GPO Box 2449, Brisbane, Qld, 4001
or calling 1300 65 11 88.



Your Local Legal Aid Queensland office:

BRISBANE

44 Herschel St, 4000

BUNDABERG

3rd Floor, WIN Tower,
Cnr Quay & Barolin Sts, 4670

CABOOLTURE

Ground Floor, Kingsgate
42 King St, 4510

CAIRNS

Level 2, Cairns Square Complex,
42-52 Abbott St, 4870

INALA

Level 1, Inala Commonwealth
Offices, 20 Wirraway Pde, 4077

IPSWICH

Level 7, 117 Brisbane St, 4305

MACKAY

Ground Floor,
17 Brisbane St, 4740

MAROOCHYDORE

Ground Floor, M1 Building
1 Duporth Ave, 4558

MOUNT ISA

6 Miles St, 4825

ROCKHAMPTON

Ground Floor, 35 Fitzroy St, 4700

SOUTHPORT

Level 2, 7 Bay St, 4215

TOOWOOMBA

1st Floor, 154 Hume St, 4350

TOWNSVILLE

3rd Floor, Northtown
280 Flinders St, 4810

WOODRIDGE

1st Floor, Woodridge Place,
Cnr Ewing Rd & Carmody St, 4114

**For more information
about our services visit
legalaid.qld.gov.au**

or phone 1300 65 11 88
or 1800 650 143 (Indigenous Hotline)

